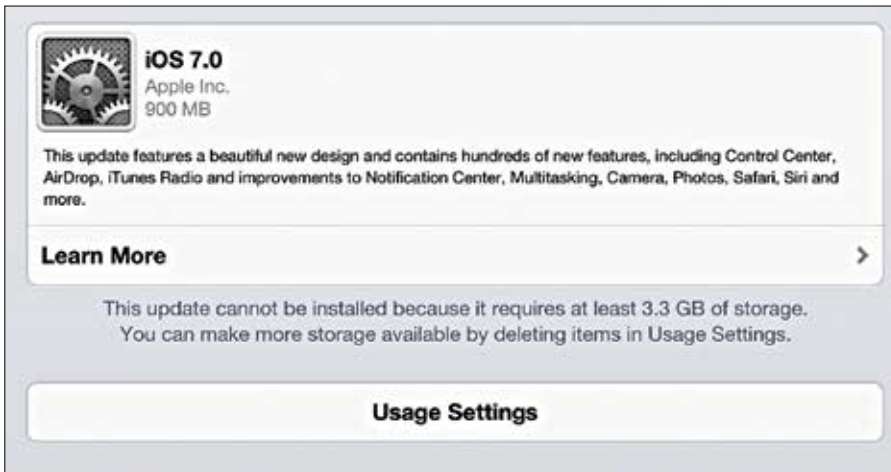




iOS wins the update battle with regular updates across all devices

Android seems to be slower with updates, as most of major handset manufacturers customise the Android experience and thus rollout updates only much after an official update is available. Google Nexus devices which run the recommended stock versions of Android are the first to get new updates. Although one can root and update a manufacturer locked device with Google's official update, there is a risk of bricking the device.

Windows Phone is pretty good with updates, and new updates are seeded globally in phases. Almost all devices get new updates, with only a few exceptions taking into account hardware support.

Score: iOS 2 - Android 1 - WP 0

UI Customisation

iOS falls short when it comes to UI customisation. The OS itself doesn't

offer any themes or widgets and one can only change wallpapers and a few colour schemes. The latest iOS 7 also has received its share of criticisms for its overall aesthetic value.

Android is the clear leader in customisation as it offers a variety of widgets, downloadable themes, wallpapers and much more.

Windows Phone has a very static UI hence customisation is limited. You can play around with tiles that act as widgets, you can change the colour scheme of the interface and also the lockscreen wallpapers, but that's it.

Score: iOS 2 - Android 2 - WP 0

Hardware Requirements

The good thing about iOS is that it doesn't require high end quad-core processors or endless gigs of RAM. The latest version of iOS has brought in support for 64-bit processors,

and the platform still runs pretty smoothly on older devices such as the iPhone 4S.

With Android it's all about the hardware. If you have top of the line hardware, you are bound to get great performance. The OS is power hungry and has brought in octa-core processing to the smartphone world. Thankfully the latest KitKat update is also supported on devices running on a mere 512MB of RAM which is some relief for low-end and older smartphone owners.

Windows Phone has also started raising the bar in the hardware department as recently Nokia launched the first quad-core smartphone with a full HD display - the Lumia 1520. The latest Black update does require one to have a smartphone



Windows is the least spec hungry

with 1GB of RAM to enjoy all the features and to make it happen Nokia has started launching smartphones with a minimum of 1GB RAM. However, it's quite clear that even on relatively low-end hardware (read: 512MB of RAM and a dual-core processor), Windows Phone still works well.

Score: iOS 2 - Android 2 - WP 1

Conclusion

As you can see, each platform has its share of pros and cons. That's why it's only fair that overall it's a tie between iOS and Android, the two biggest mobile operating systems out there. Windows Phone is relatively new, but don't count it out, because it is offering some exciting devices at some very enticing price points. Soon we might find a three way tie if Microsoft and Nokia keep at it.

Winner: iOS and Android (it's a tie!)



Android wins hands down on UI customisation